Q+A

MIND OF THE MASTER

In his latest book, grandmaster and five-time world chess champion VISWANATHAN ANAND outlines 64 life lessons, one for every square on the chessboard

Q. Why did you decide to write *Lightning Kid*?

I was interested in taking a lot of the experiences that I had shared in my previous book *Mind Master* (2019), besides some different ones, and presenting them to a younger audience. Perhaps, I was also influenced by the fact that watching my son grow, you feel something from your own life may be a useful story for youngsters to relate to.

Q. What is the one lesson from your childhood days that has remained with you?

The need to work hard and the idea that you earn your results is something that has stayed with me. It is something that I learned really fast and continue to do, even today.

Q. What made you return to the competitive circuit at the Tata Steel Chess in Kolkata?

I caught the bug when I was attending the Tata Steel tournament as a guest over the last few years. It was harder not playing and I was keen to start competing a little bit more. I also feel that playing 1-2 tournaments requires the same amount of effort as 4-5 because you have a lot of catching up to do before any event.

Q. How does it feel to play some of the opponents whom you've been a mentor to?

The morning before the game, I just think that these are strong players. If they had a different name and were from a different country, I would just go and sit across them in a certain way. And I do just that. You have to treat them as the absolute top players of the world, which they are. Working with them benefitted me.

—*with* ***Shail Desai***



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